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Phase 3 Validation: Which Cluster is the best fit for Saint Ann's?

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Recap of Methodology

Phase 1

Narrowed from 2,500+ SA2 suburbs to ~100 using filters (income, children, education, occupation).

Phase 2

Refined shortlist to 3 main clusters:

- *Hills District*
- *Upper North Shore (UNS)*
- *Lower North Shore (LNS)*

Phase 3

Validate clusters in depth to recommend the most viable and potential catchment area for Saint Ann's.

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Key Analysis In Phase 3

a. Household Income Threshold Update

e. Age Distribution

d. Political Landscape

b.Competitor Analysis

c. Transportation & Accessibility

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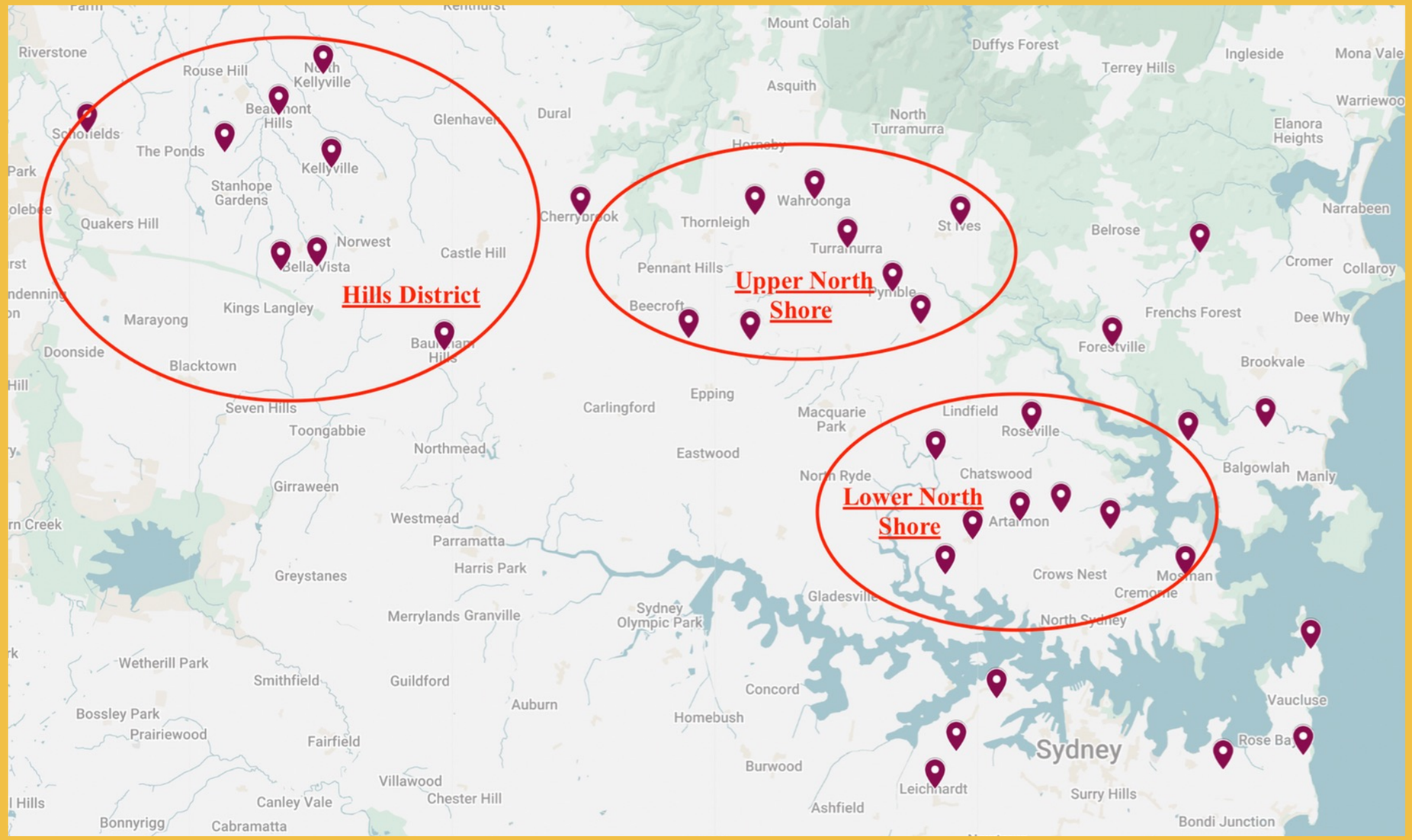

Analysed Clusters

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a. Household Income Threshold Update

Suburbs	Cluster	Income >$5k	Total HHs	% High-I-HHs
CHATSWOOD (WEST) - LANE COVE NORTH	Lower North Shore	1305	9324	14.00%
ARTARMON	Lower North Shore	504	4082	12.35%
CHATSWOOD - EAST	Lower North Shore	862	8606	10.02%
LANE COVE	Lower North Shore	1137	6901	16.48%
LINDFIELD - ROSEVILLE	Lower North Shore	2087	9255	22.55%
MOSMAN - NORTH	Lower North Shore	1300	6694	19.42%
MOSMAN - SOUTH	Lower North Shore	1444	6709	21.52%
	Lower North Shore Total	***8639***	***51571***	***16.75%***
BAULKHAM HILLS - EAST	The Hills	887	9032	9.82%
BAULKHAM HILLS (WEST) - BELLA VISTA	The Hills	1279	7389	17.31%
CASTLE HILL - CENTRAL	The Hills	311	2827	11.00%
CASTLE HILL - EAST	The Hills	284	2110	13.46%
CASTLE HILL - NORTH	The Hills	726	4168	17.42%
CASTLE HILL - SOUTH	The Hills	476	3745	12.71%
CASTLE HILL - WEST	The Hills	344	1605	21.43%
KELLYVILLE - EAST	The Hills	932	5478	17.01%
KELLYVILLE - WEST	The Hills	658	3842	17.13%
NORTH KELLYVILLE	The Hills	875	5458	16.03%
ROUSE HILL - BEAUMONT HILLS	The Hills	938	5382	17.43%
KELLYVILLE RIDGE - THE PONDS	The Hills	904	6294	14.36%
	The Hills Total	***8614***	***57330***	***15.03%***
WAHROONGA (WEST) - WAITARA	Upper North Shore	389	4929	7.89%
PYMBLE	Upper North Shore	1573	6081	25.87%
ST IVES	Upper North Shore	1651	7823	21.10%
TURRAMURRA	Upper North Shore	1667	7610	21.91%
WAHROONGA (EAST) - WARRAWEE	Upper North Shore	1556	6430	24.20%
	Upper North Shore Total	***6836***	***32873***	***20.80%***

Source: https://www.abs.gov.au/census

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Clusters	No. of Households	% of high-income households
Upper North Shore	6836	20.80%
Lower North Shore	8639	16.75%
The Hills	8614	15.03%

a. Household Income Threshold Update

The Hills | **Lower North Shore**

Larger household numbers, but lower concentration of high-income families

Upper North Shore

Highest % of high-income households (20.8%) despite fewer households

>>>>> **Upper North Shore** is the **strongest on wealth,**
Lower North Shore is the **strongest on scale,**
and **the Hills** have **potential** but **more challenges.**

b. Competitor Analysis

Cluster	School	Education	School Type	Gender
The Hills	Lorien Novalis School	Steiner	Combined (Pre K-12)	Co-Ed
	The Hills Montessori School	Montessori	Primary (Pre K-K)	Co-Ed
	Cathwest Innovation College - Loyola Campus	Other Alternative	Secondary (Y10-Y12)	Co-Ed
Upper North Shore	Northside Montessori School	Montessori	Primary (K-6)	Co-Ed
	Lindfield Montessori Preschool	Montessori	Primary (only K)	Co-Ed
	Forestville Montessori School	Montessori	Primary (K-6)	Co-Ed
	Bradfield Senior College	Other Alternative	Secondary (Y11-Y12)	Co-Ed
Lower North Shore	Cameragal Montessori School	Montessori	Primary (Pre K-Y6)	Co-Ed
	Glenaeon Rudolf Steiner School	Steiner	Combined (Pre K-12)	Co-Ed
	Castlecrag Montessori School	Montessori	Primary (only K)	Co-Ed
	The Farmhouse Montessori School	Montessori	Primary (K-Y6)	Co-Ed

Source: https://www.australianschoolsdirectory.com.au/alternative-schools

- **The Hills = fragmented competition, untapped opportunity for K-12**
- **Upper North Shore = high potential, less competition in secondary**
- **Lower North Shore = stronger competition, but fragmented age offerings**

c. Transportation and Accessibility

The Hills

Castle Hill & Bella Vista **strong (metro + parking), but many suburbs rely heavily on buses; weaker walkability.**

Upper North Shore

Pymble & Wahroonga **strong (rail + walkability).**
St Ives **weaker (no train station).**

Lower North Shore

Chatswood & Artarmon **excellent (rail + bus + walkability).**
Mosman & Lane Cove **rely on buses, but still strong urban planning.**

>>>>> ***Implication: UNS and LNS are more reliable for accessibility; Hills requires more car reliance.***

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c. Transportation and Accessibility

Cluster	Suburb	Train Station	Major Bus Routes	Public Parking Spaces	Notes
Hills District	Rouse Hill	Tallawong Metro	15+ (Busways, Hillsbus)	~300+ (Town Centre)	Metro hub with direct school access
	North Kellyville	None	5+ (CDC NSW)	~150+ (local shops)	Relies on bus route 617
	Beaumont Hills	None	6+ (to Kellyville & Castle Hill)	~180+	Good bus links to metro
	Kellyville	Kellyville Metro	10+ (Hillsbus, Busways)	~250+ (Kellyville Village)	Strong metro + school access
	Norwest	Norwest Metro	12+ (business & school)	~400+ (Norwest Marketown)	Excellent for drop-offs
	Baulkham Hills	None	10+ (to Parramatta & Castle Hill)	~220+ (Stockland Mall)	High bus frequency
	Castle Hill	Castle Hill Metro	20+ (major interchange)	~500+ (Castle Towers)	Best overall transport mix
	Bella Vista	Bella Vista	10+	~350+	Great for school commuting
Upper North Shore	Wahroonga	T1 Line	10+ (school buses)	~240+	Near Abbotsleigh & Barker
	Turramurra	T1 Line	8+	~180+	Station car park + plaza
	St Ives	None	15+	~394+ (Shopping Village)	Strong bus network
	Pymble	T1 Line	10+	~245+	Near PLC & Knox Grammar
Lower North Shore	Roseville	T1 Line	6+	~180+	Local station access
	Chatswood	T1 + Metro	20+	~600+ (Westfield & CBD)	Major transport hub
	Mosman	None	15+	~350+	Heavy reliance on buses
	Lane Cove	None	10+	~300+	Strong bus interchange
	Artarmon	T1 Line	8+	~200+	Near business park

Source: https://www.abs.gov.au/census, https://busmaps.com/en/australia/region/2155400

d. Political Views

The Hills	Upper North Shore	Lower North Shore
Traditionally conservative, many of the suburbs has the Liberal party with majority vote	**Traditionally conservative**, change of party within HOR but stays with Liberal at Senate level	**Often change in party**, swings between Labor and Liberal, or Independent and Liberal

Source:
results.aec.gov.au

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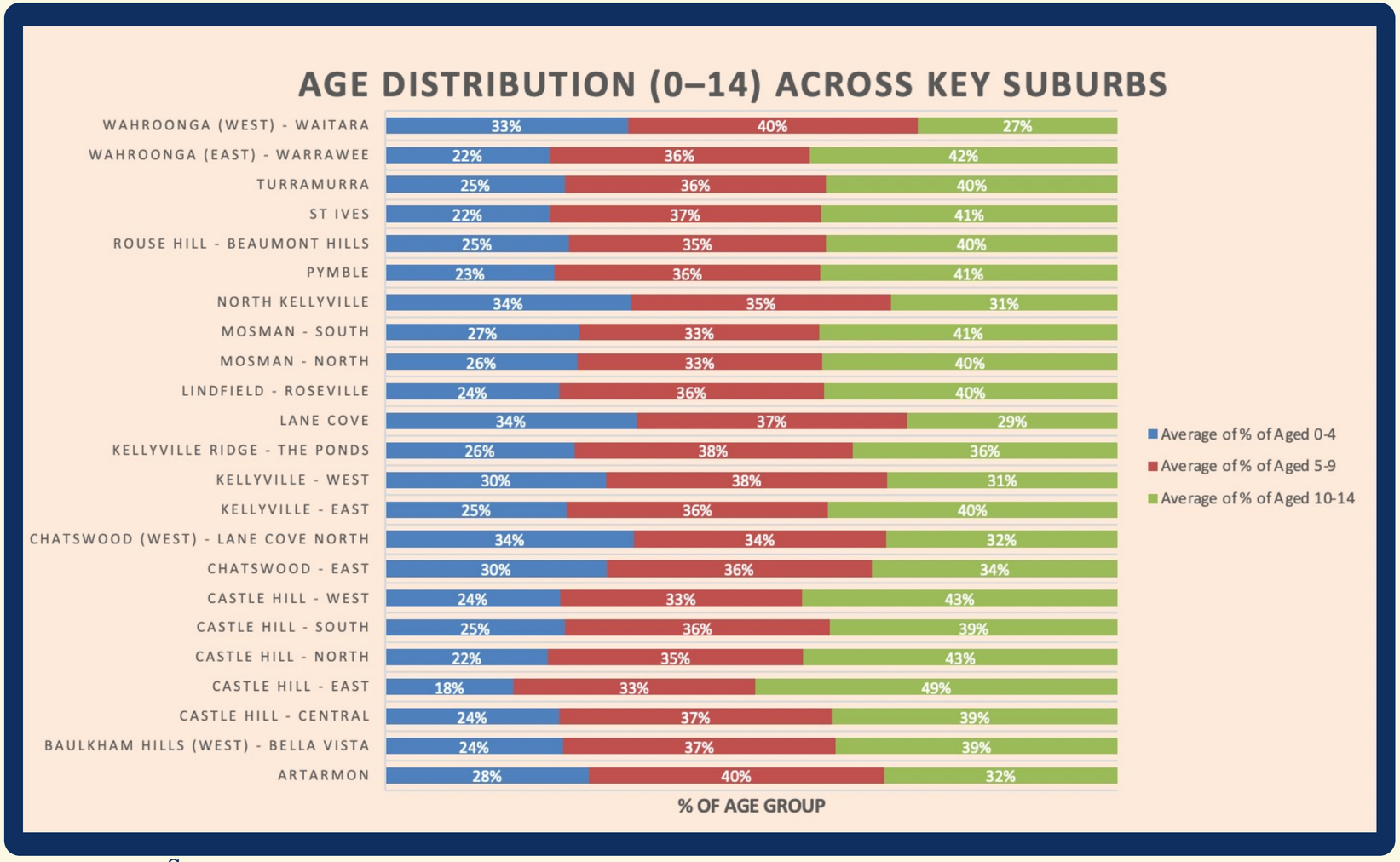
e. Age Distribution *(Identifying Opportunities for Grade-Level Entry Focus)*



Findings: Distribution is balanced across suburbs, no dominant age group.

Implication: Saint Ann's should adopt a broad-entry strategy (multiple year levels, not just primary or secondary).

Source: https://www.abs.gov.au/census

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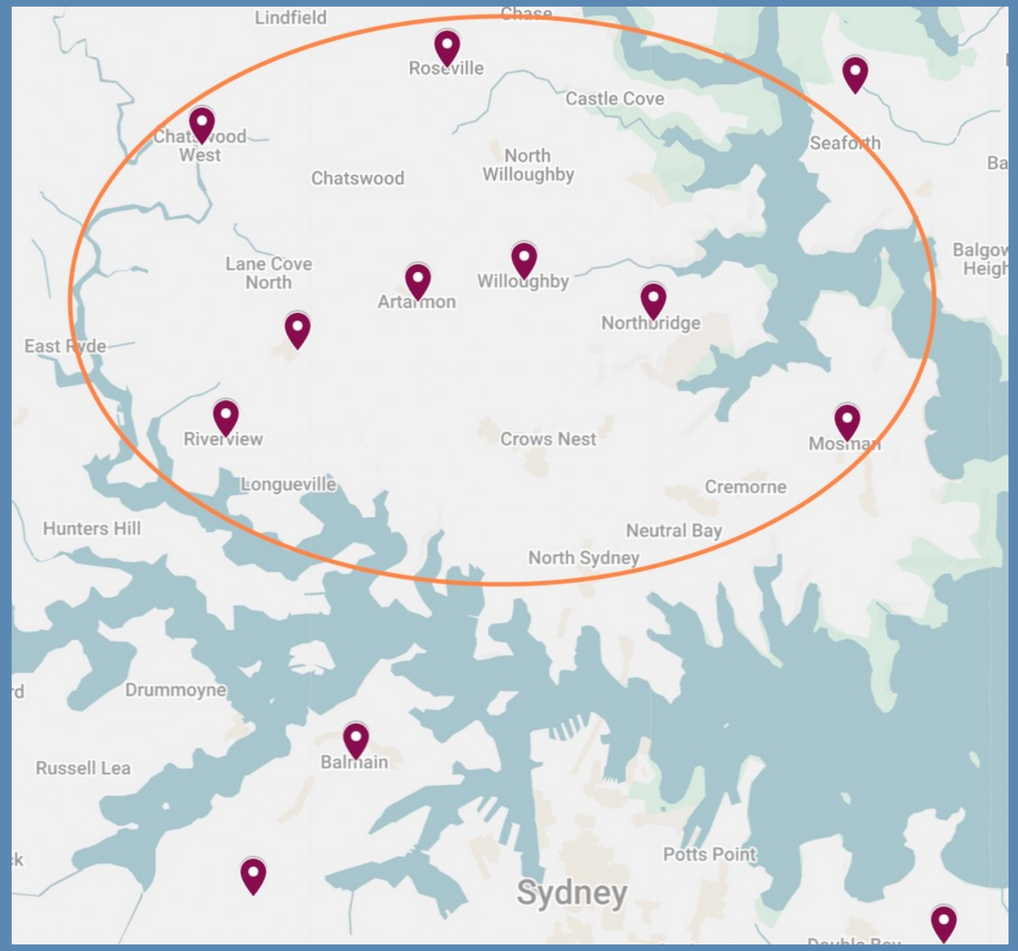
TO SUMMARISE....

	The Hills	Upper North Shore	Lower North Shore
HH Income ($5000<)	***8614*** households ***(15.03%)***	***6836*** households ***(20.80%)***	***8639*** households ***(16.75%)***
Competitors	***3 schools*** with alternative education	***3 schools*** with alternative education	***5 schools*** with alternative education
Transportation	**Despite some suburbs lacking train access,** the **high bus connectivity** and **close proximity** between suburbs maintain **strong overall accessibility across all clusters.**		
Emotional Appeals - Political views	***Conservative*** (Long history of Liberal party) - Less change of party	***Conservative*** (Long history of Liberal party) - Sometimes changes party	***Often changes*** party in elections → More open to change
Age band	**Similar across all clusters**		

FINAL RECOMMENDATION



LOWER NORTH SHORE

- **Large household base**
  - **Highest total households with income $5000<**
- **High population of children**
- **Progressive openness**
- **Excellent transport**
- **Competition is high but differentiated from Saint Ann's model**

THANK YOU!